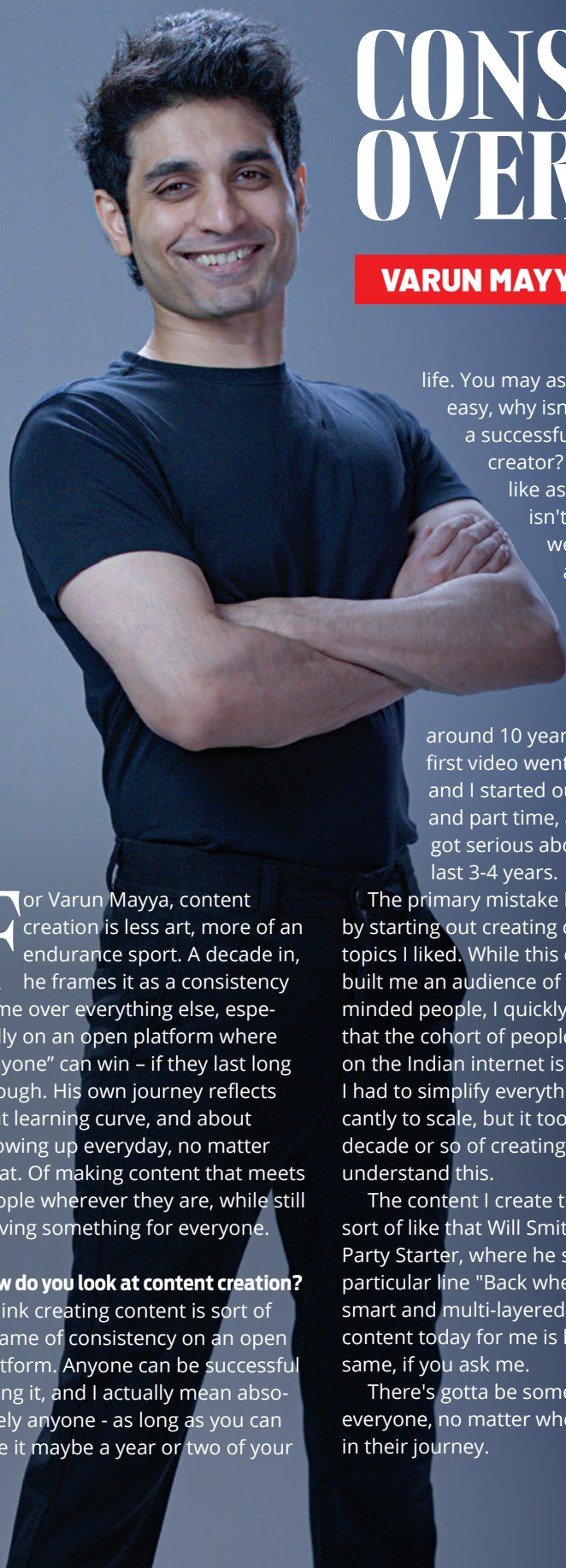


CONSISTENCY OVER GENIUS

VARUN MAYYA'S TIPS FOR CREATORS



For Varun Mayya, content creation is less art, more of an endurance sport. A decade in, he frames it as a consistency game over everything else, especially on an open platform where "anyone" can win – if they last long enough. His own journey reflects that learning curve, and about showing up everyday, no matter what. Of making content that meets people wherever they are, while still leaving something for everyone.

How do you look at content creation?

I think creating content is sort of a game of consistency on an open platform. Anyone can be successful doing it, and I actually mean absolutely anyone - as long as you can give it maybe a year or two of your

life. You may ask, if it's that easy, why isn't everyone a successful content creator? But that's like asking why isn't everyone well-built if anyone can use the gym. Honestly I've been at it for around 10 years now. My first video went live in 2016 and I started out casual and part time, and I only got serious about it in the last 3-4 years.

The primary mistake I made was by starting out creating content on topics I liked. While this of course built me an audience of very like minded people, I quickly realized that the cohort of people like me on the Indian internet is very small. I had to simplify everything significantly to scale, but it took me half a decade or so of creating content to understand this.

The content I create today is sort of like that Will Smith song, Party Starter, where he says this particular line "Back when rap was smart and multi-layered" – creating content today for me is kind of the same, if you ask me.

There's gotta be something for everyone, no matter where they are in their journey.

In 2026 and beyond, how does a creator maintain a "soul" when their digital twin is doing 99% of the heavy lifting?

I think format is a good separation. My AI avatar handles most of the heavy lifting for short-form content because my audience there expects news. But on long form, I put in real, manual effort to do 30 min-1 hour long videos.

Without this, I'd build virtually no loyalty and simply be an outlet for news. This separation of format is a good trick to maintain the scale and volume benefits of short form content but still build deep connections with your audience on long form content.

Can the Indian creator economy actually break the social pressure cycle, or is it just creating a new tier of digital labourers?

I think we are all slaves to the algorithm in some sense. Even if you don't create content. In my opinion, the most impact that comes from creating content is the future ability to do bold things.

If you have the scale as a content creator, you have your own audience support to shield you from the conformist nature of the rest of social media while you tackle big problems.

That's why some of the world's biggest creators are now entering business and pushing themselves to try difficult things. **d**